Contracts: Facilitator Guide

Business Academy Group Learning · Contracts · June 2027

Session at a glance

In 60 minutes, providers learn what to include in family enrollment agreements, how to read vendor contracts, and how to keep all their agreements organized with key dates tracked.

Item	Detail
Month	June 2027
Audience	Business Academy providers, center-based and home-based
Length	60 minutes
Format	[In person / virtual]
Materials	Sample enrollment agreement, sample vendor contract with key terms highlighted, contract tracker template, printed Tips and Tricks sheet and Provider Handout
Ask providers to bring	Their current enrollment agreement and one vendor or service contract (lease, insurance, software, or supplies)

Learning goals

By the end, each provider can:

1. Name the key parts of a strong family enrollment agreement.
2. Find the important terms in a vendor contract: cost, length, renewal, and cancellation.
3. Start a simple contract tracker with renewal dates.
4. Know when to get professional help before signing.

Agenda

Time	Segment
0:00 – 0:05	Welcome and opener: “The contract that surprised me”
0:05 – 0:15	Why contracts matter: protecting income and avoiding surprises
0:15 – 0:30	Enrollment agreements, vendor contracts, and staff agreements
0:30 – 0:45	Activity: Contract scavenger hunt
0:45 – 0:55	Implementation: your 30-day plan and one commitment
0:55 – 1:00	Takeaways and wrap-up

Why contracts matter

Opener, “The contract that surprised me”: Ask providers to share a time a contract or agreement surprised them, such as an automatic renewal, a cancellation fee, or a family who left without notice.

Talking points:

- **Contracts set expectations.** Everyone knows what was agreed to before a problem comes up.
- **Enrollment agreements protect income.** Notice periods and payment terms keep revenue predictable.
- **Vendor contracts hide costs.** Auto-renewals, price increases, and cancellation fees are often in the fine print.
- **Dates matter.** Missing a renewal or cancellation deadline can lock you in for another year.
- **Know your limits.** For leases, loans, and anything high-stakes, professional review is worth it.

Core content: the agreements that run your business

Family enrollment agreement

Part	What to include
Parties and child	Names, child’s name and age, start date
Schedule	Days and hours of care
Tuition	Rate, due date, payment method, late fees, deposit or registration fee
Notice to withdraw	How much written notice is required and what is owed
Policies	Statement that the family received and agrees to the handbook
Changes	How rate or schedule changes are made and how much notice is given
Signatures	Family and provider signatures and dates

Reading a vendor contract

- **Cost:** total price, payment schedule, and any planned increases.
- **Length:** start and end dates.
- **Renewal:** does it renew automatically, and for how long?
- **Cancellation:** how much notice is needed and what fees apply.
- **Responsibilities:** what the vendor must do, and what you must do.

Staff and contractor agreements

Offer letters and job descriptions set clear expectations for employees. If using independent contractors (such as a cleaning service or a music teacher), a written agreement should describe the work and payment. Whether someone is an employee or a contractor depends on the work arrangement, not the label, so check with a tax professional if unsure.

This session is general guidance, not legal advice. Providers should have a qualified professional review leases, loans, and other high-stakes agreements.

Implementation: your 30-day plan

Each provider leaves with one commitment and a 4-week plan; the Business Specialist checks progress at the next coaching session. Progress here also counts toward the pilot goal of at least one new or improved business practice per provider.

Week	Action	Done when
Week 1	Compare your enrollment agreement to the checklist; mark missing parts.	Gaps are marked
Week 2	Gather every vendor contract and service agreement in one place.	All contracts are collected
Week 3	Start a contract tracker: vendor, cost, end date, renewal and cancellation terms.	Tracker is started
Week 4	Add renewal and cancellation deadlines to your calendar with reminders.	Key dates are on the calendar

Tie-in to coaching

At the next individual coaching session, the Business Specialist will:

- ☐ Review the enrollment agreement for missing parts
- ☐ Look at the contract tracker and upcoming renewals
- ☐ Identify any contract that needs professional review
- ☐ Note any business practice change in the provider's progress record

Commitment card

Have providers fill this in before they leave and keep a copy:

- The part missing from my enrollment agreement: _____
- The next contract that renews: _____
- Where I will keep my contract tracker: _____
- A contract I want reviewed by a professional: _____

Key takeaways

Close the session by reading these aloud; they also appear on the Provider Handout.

1. **Put it in writing.** Every family and vendor relationship should have a signed agreement.
2. **Read the fine print.** Look for cost increases, auto-renewals, and cancellation fees.
3. **Track the dates.** Renewal and cancellation deadlines belong on your calendar.
4. **Keep copies organized.** One folder or tracker for all your agreements.
5. **Get help for big decisions.** Have leases and loans reviewed before signing.

Activities and discussion

Activity: Contract scavenger hunt (15 minutes)

Using a sample vendor contract, pairs race to find: the total cost, the end date, the auto-renewal clause, the cancellation notice period, and any fees. Then providers repeat the hunt on a contract they brought and add what they find to their tracker.

Discussion questions

- Has an auto-renewal or cancellation fee ever caught you off guard?
- How much notice do you require when families leave?
- Which vendor relationships matter most to your program?
- Where do you keep your contracts today?

Peer Connections prompt (June)

“Parent contracts and vendor agreements.” Providers share one clause in their enrollment agreement that has saved them trouble, and one vendor they’ve had a good (or bad) experience with.

Handouts for this session

Walk through the **Contracts Tips and Tricks** sheet during the content segment, and give out the **Contracts Provider Handout** at the end.

General guidance only, not legal or tax advice. Consult a qualified professional before signing leases, loans, or other high-stakes agreements.